冬

Зима

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掌中雀
Sparrow in Hand BTE-01

Back to Earth
重返人间

Sparrow in Hand
掌中雀

Library, Suitcase
箱中图书室

Two figures are reading, illuminated by the soft lights of the library.
图书室内，柔软灯光下的阅读时间。

They sit in comfortable harmony, a tacit understanding between them.
一种舒适的默契和平衡，在空间中流淌。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗: ……

The only sound is the turning of pages.
安静得仅余书页翻动的声音。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗: ……

It is a silence that will break as their mutual agreement ends.
沉默作为一种由社群共识维持的状态，终究会因共识破灭结束。

After all, this girl has a question forming in her mind.
毕竟，女孩一直思考着如何开口。

Sonetto: Excuse me, Mr. Зима ...
十四行诗: 冬先生，请问……

It seems the man is in a world of his own. He does not even notice her voice.
——对方似乎沉浸在自己的世界里，丝毫没有察觉。

The girl lowers her tone. It is shorter, urgent, and almost piercing.
女孩于是压低了声音。更短，却更急促。几乎振聋发聩。

Sonetto: Mr. Зима!
十四行诗: 冬先生！

зима and Зима snap out of their trance.
“冬”与冬一齐，被震得醒来。

Зима: W-What?
冬: 什，什么?

Sonetto: Sorry, maybe I shouldn't ask you here ...
十四行诗: 抱歉，虽然也许不应该在这里提问……

Sonetto: ... but you have the most extensive knowledge of poetic imagery of anyone I know. I have a question that's been bothering me for a while—
十四行诗: 但您是我认识的人当中，对诗歌意象了解最为广泛的。有一个问题已困扰我许久——

The chickadee on his shoulder shakes its head in surprise and takes flight.
山雀慌乱地摇头，甚至再次飞了起来。

She takes no notice, fully focused on receiving her answer.
可惜，急于寻求答案的女孩并未留意。

Sonetto: I've been wondering ... What's your interpretation of "a sparrow in hand" and "a goose in the sky"?
十四行诗：我想知道，您是怎样看待，“掌中之雀”和“空中之雁”这两种意象的?

Sonetto: Is it simply referring to these two animals literally, or does it include all the extended symbolism from previous works?
十四行诗：“雀”与“雁”，是仅仅实指语义上的这两种动物，还是包括了它们在以往作品中延伸的、所有的虚指含义?

Sonetto: Or perhaps, as some suggest ... this is some kind of highly directional metaphor?
十四行诗：或者还是如部分观点所说……这是某种指向性极强的隐喻?

Зима: ...
冬：……

Зима silently picks up a pen, preparing to write his response in the book lying open in front of him.
沉默中，冬提笔，似乎打算将自己的看法，写在面前摊开的书上。

Sonetto keenly perceives his intent.
而这意图几乎立刻被敏锐地察觉了。

Sonetto: Ah—please don't do that.
十四行诗：啊——请不要这样做。

The chickadee tilts its head, seemingly confused. Perhaps even a little annoyed.
山雀歪了歪头，表情流露出许多不解，和一点点被捉弄的恼怒。

Sonetto: These books are from Timekeeper's collection ...
十四行诗：这些都是司辰的藏书……

Sonetto: ... If you write on its pages in ink, it'll spoil the experience for the next reader.
十四行诗：而且在上面用墨水写字，可能也会影响之后其他的借阅者。

Зима: ... S-sorry.
冬：……抱，抱歉。

Зима: It's not ... stone ... anymore. I ... forgot ...
冬：这不是……不再是……石头。我……忘记了……

Sonetto: It's because you don't have any blank paper. Here, use this notebook.
十四行诗：原来是因为您没有空白的纸了。这儿有一些没用过的笔记本，您可以试试……

Sonetto: Just like your piles of parchment, I've filled many notebooks. Writing down my thoughts ... helps me clear my head.
十四行诗：就像您这些满满当当的羊皮纸一样，我也已经写满了许多笔记本。记录想法……可以帮我理清思绪。

Зима: I ... u-use parchment ... to write.
冬：我……用，用羊皮纸，写。

Sonetto: Of course. Parchment is a very good choice.
十四行诗：当然。羊皮纸也是很好的选择。

Sonetto: I think there's some over there ... I'll go look for it. Hold on.
十四行诗：我记得这边还有一些——可以找找。请稍等。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Sonetto: It should be here ... Ah, found it.
十四行诗: 应该在这里的……啊，找到了。

When she turns around, a breath of cold air sweeps past her.
当她转身，感觉到一阵冷然的气息掠过。

The book remains open on the desk. The quill, its owner, and the chickadee named "зима" have all disappeared.
书还在桌面上摊开。羽毛笔同他的主人，与名为“冬”的山雀，一起消失了。

Sonetto: Mr. Зима ...?
十四行诗: 冬先生……?

Sonetto: Did I say something wrong ...?
十四行诗: 是我说错了什么吗……

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Sonetto: Every time I ask him a question, it seems like he doesn't want to answer.
十四行诗: 每次提问，他似乎都不愿回答。

Sonetto: And what did he mean by "stone"?
十四行诗: “石头”，又是指什么呢?

Sonetto: Well ... I could take a look at his file. Maybe it'll help me avoid making the same mistake again.
十四行诗: 好吧，只是看一下。也许了解原因，下次就能规避这种错误了。

Sonetto: I'll just take a little peek ...
十四行诗: 只是看一下——

Sonetto: ...?
十四行诗: ……?

The file contains only a few pages, despite covering half of his life within it.
档案只有寥寥数页。一个人的前半生即被囊括其中。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

黑林私语
Whispers in Black Forest BTE-02

Whispers in Black Forest
黑林私语

Sonetto stands under the overhead light, slowly reading aloud the words in her hands.
十四行诗站在顶光下，将手中的文字轻缓地读出声来。

Sonetto: "In 1912, the poet was charged with 'insulting the highest authorities.' He was sent to Eastern Siberia, then transferred through various prisons, and eventually exiled to a solitary island."
十四行诗: “1912 年，诗人被定以‘侮辱最高当局’罪名，押送至东西伯利亚，随后通过转运监狱，流放孤岛。”

Sonetto: "Over the next decade, he lived there in isolation ..."
十四行诗: “此后十余年，定居于此……”

Sonetto: "His poetry ... was inseparable from ... the animals on the island ..."
十四行诗: “与岛屿上的动物……诗歌……形影不离……”

In the forest, Зима sits on a rock in a clearing.
林中，冬正坐在空地的岩石上。

A group of animals surrounds him. A small forest gathering.
许多动物环绕着他。此处，俨然一个小型的森林集会。

Зима: ..."*Believe not in the unbelievable,*"
"*And touch not that which is untouchable,*"
冬: ——“对不可相信的话，请别相信”

“对不可触碰之物，请别伸手”

A brown bear beside him places a thick paw on his arm, making the parchment in his hand wobble.
身边，棕熊抬起厚实的手掌，搭到他举着羊皮纸的小臂上。

Зима: Sir, please don't touch ...
冬: 先生，请别伸手……

Зима: There should be no pause here. It interrupts the meter.
冬: 这里，不该停顿。韵脚会乱。

Зима: Ahem.
冬: 咳。

Зима: *"Look not back on the path you did not take,"*
"Iron wings, a warning to the hunter makes."
"Yet in his greed, he disregards it still."
冬: “对不可后悔的路，请别回头”

“铁翅对猎人，如此告诫”

“可这猎人，轻信且贪婪”

On his left, a fox paws his sleeve disapprovingly.
左边，铅灰色的狐狸不满地衔住他的衣袖。

Зима: Please behave. Wait until I'm done ...
冬: 请认真些，先听完……

Зима: ..."*Try as he might he cannot reach his prey,*"
"*Futility destroys his world this day.*"
冬: ——“不得所求”

“便妄图抹杀所有”

A sable drapes itself around his neck. It whispers in his ear.
黑貂亲热地围着他的脖子，窃窃私语。

Зима: ... Yes, you're right. The hunter is simply incorrigible.
冬: ……是的。您说得对。这位猎人先生，简直无药可救。

Зима: And ... I'm afraid there are still many such people in the world.
冬: 并且……恐怕现在，仍有这样的人。

Зима: May they reap what they sow ...
冬: 愿他们，自食其果……

In the background of this harmonious scene, a reindeer shakes its antlers.
融洽的景象中，站在身后，驯鹿轻轻摇晃巨大的双角。

Her dissent nearly knocks the poet off the rock upon which he is sitting.
一些反对意见的苗头，险些把诗人从岩石上晃了下去。

Зима: Ah, miss ...!
冬：啊，小姐……！

Зима: I ... ahem, ahem. I understand.
冬：我，咳咳。我明白。

Зима: You're saying that the hunter is just trying to survive ... I ... I simply don't agree.
冬：但您说，猎人，也只是为了生存……这我……我不能同意。

Зима: It is out of vanity, not hunger, that he refuses to return empty-handed.
冬：是虚荣，使他拒绝空手而归，不是饥饿。

Зима: Are there truly gems in a pigeon's belly? The branch it perches on cannot bear, um, the weight of a man ...
冬：鸽子的腹中，真的会有宝石吗？它所站的枝桠，也承受不起，呃，一个男子的重量……

Зима: The hunter aims to persecute the pigeon, yet it warns him. When he falls into the snow, the snow embraces him.
冬：猎人，要迫害鸽子，鸽子却告诫他；跌落进雪地，雪地也接纳他。

Зима: Truly ... forgiving.
冬：真是……宽容。

Зима: Yes, it reminds me of ...
冬：对呀，这令我、想起……

Зима: *"How can we not love earth more than heaven?"*
冬：“我们怎能不爱人间，更胜过天堂?”

Зима: Nature is the fabric of our world.
冬：自然，是人间的远景。

Зима: We are like potted plants ... placed amidst its great garden.
冬：我们像盆栽……被放置其中。

A chickadee flies from afar, landing firmly and accurately on his shoulder.
山雀从远处飞来，稳当、准确地落在他肩膀上。

Surprise and intimacy. A pair of long-lost friends.
惊喜，亲昵，一对久违的友人。

Зима: My friend!
冬：我的朋友！

Зима: You've been gone for so long. I had begun to think that you had fallen into a ... a hunter's trap.
冬：你似乎去了，太久。我快以为你，是落入了哪……哪个猎人的陷阱。

The surrounding animals immediately become alert.
动物们几乎立刻便警戒起来。

Зима: But there are no hunters here ...
冬：虽然，这里并没有什么，“猎人”……

Зима: Just us.
冬：只有我们。

The hickadee shakes its head and chirps, displeased.
山雀却摇头，吱吱喳喳，模样并不畅快。

It looks desperate for the full attention of its friends.
它看上去急切地需要来自朋友的全部注意力。

Зима: What did you say?
冬：你说什么?

Зима: Wha—
冬：什……

Зима: ...!
冬：……!

Зима: ... No, I, ahem! Ahem, ahem. I should ... go ...
冬：……不，我，咳！咳咳。我得，走了……

The news leaves him trembling. Зима's papers scatter to the ground, but he is too hurried to pick them up.
这消息令他浑身震悚，手中稿纸散落一地，甚至来不及捡拾。

He leaps down from the rock, puts out the fire, and disappears into the depths of the forest.
冬跳下岩石，踏灭了篝火，随即往针叶林的更深处躲去。

His friends, of course, follow close behind.
“朋友们”，当然也随他跑走。

"According to the poet's own account, the years on the island were marked by 'bitter cold and loyal companions.'"
“据诗人本人描述，岛上的岁月伴随着‘苦寒，与忠诚的朋友’。”

Sonetto: "'Many friends ...'"
十四行诗：“‘很多朋友……’”

By now, she has fallen into a nearby chair and is sitting in contemplation. Her gaze lingers on the file.
女孩思索着，视线停留在档案上。

"These quiet years lasted at least until the mid-1920s."
“而这段平静岁月，至少持续到 20 年代中叶。”

"Until a human journalist from the government set foot in that land of the Far East."
“直到当局的人类记者踏上了这片极东的土地。”

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

我自愿流放!
Self-Exile BTE-03

Self-exile
我自愿流放!

Journalist: It's so ... desolate.
记者：真是荒凉……

Journalist: Compared to this place, Tobolsk is like the Leningrad of Siberia.
记者：和这里比起来，托博尔斯克简直就像西伯利亚的列宁格勒。

Journalist: There must be a bounty of untapped resources here.
记者：这地方一定还有很多未开发的资源。

Sailor: I'd be more focused on finding a place to stay if I were you.
船员：别想太多。先赶紧给自己找个落脚的地方吧，年轻人。

Journalist: In what direction is the nearest town? How far is it?
记者：请问离这最近的城镇，在哪个方向？有多远呢？

Sailor: Town? There's nothing but prisons here, lad.
船员：这儿只有监狱，孩子。

Journalist: ... Prisons?
记者：……只有监狱？

Sailor: You heard me. Not even a pigeon would stop to crap in this cesspit.
船员：是的，监狱。欢迎来到这鸟都不停下来拉屎的鬼地方。

Journalist: So, where are these prisons?
记者：那最近的监狱在——

Sailor: You're in one, mate.
船员：你的脚下。

Journalist: Ha! I get it. You're messing with me.
记者：……您不愿告诉我，也不必这样捉弄我。

Sailor: Tsk. You came all this way, and you don't even know a single thing about this place. You're dead meat.
船员：来到这种地方，却什么也不知道。你会丢命的。

Journalist: I just came here to investigate ...
记者：我来这里，正是为了调查……

Sailor: Head south. Or buy another ticket and come back with us. That's my suggestion.
船员：往南走，或者再买张票跟我们一起回去。这是我的建议。

Journalist: I ... can't.
记者：这可……不行。

Journalist: When will your ship come back again?
记者：您的船下次来，是什么时候？

Sailor: Side barges are centrally managed ... It could be 15 days. Maybe longer.
船员：边部驳船由区中央统一管理……可能得等上十五日。或者更久。

Sailor: Until then, do your best to stay alive.
船员：在那之前，先活着吧。

"The government journalist discovered the poems and stories while searching for shelter."
“四处寻找容身之所的当局记者，发现了那些诗歌和故事。”

"They were written on pieces of wood, stones, and scattered parchment."
“在木片上、石头上，在散落的羊皮纸上。”

"Ecstatic at his discovery, the journalist set out to identify the author and collect them all."
“记者欣喜若狂，决定找到作者，好将它们全数收下。”

Sonetto: Mr. Зима ... doesn't seem like someone who could handle something like that.
十四行诗：冬先生……似乎没办法应付这样的事。

Journalist: If it weren't for these stone-paved roads, I swear, I would have marked this place as a "no man's land."
记者：如果没有这些石头铺成的路，我发誓，我一定会把这儿记录成“无人区”。

In an opening not far away, crude shacks, some empty or collapsed, stretch out like long scars torn into the earth.
不远处，空地上的简陋棚屋，或空置，或坍塌，连成一片，像地表被撕开的长长伤疤。

At the center lies an extinguished campfire.
这疤痕突兀地静止在这儿，与熄灭的篝火堆一同沉默。

Journalist: What about those people who were exiled about a decade ago? Did they all escape?
记者：十多年前被流放的那些人呢？难道全部逃走了？

Journalist: In those surviving records, the end of the exile policy ...
记者：那些现存记录里，流放政策的尾声……

Journalist: But ... anyone who found themselves in this environment must have constantly thought of escaping.
记者：不过，这种环境……无论谁来，肯定都时刻想着逃走。

Journalist: Forget it. I'll look for traces of life first. Maybe I'll find ...
记者：算了。先观察一下生活痕迹，也许会有发现——

Journalist: Huh? The fire. It's still warm.
记者：咦？篝火竟然还有余温？

Journalist: Is this ...?
记者：这是……？

Half-burned parchment is scattered around the campfire in a scene of attempted destruction. He picks up one sheet.
看上去有些年头的羊皮纸，散落在篝火周围。一种毁尸灭迹未遂的现场。

Journalist: ... Parchment paper with poetry on it and a still-smoldering campfire!
记者：——这些稿纸，这些诗句！尚有余温的篝火！

Journalist: Someone is definitely here!
记者：这儿一定有人来过！

Journalist: Who could it be? Who would write poetry in a place like this?
记者：是谁？谁在这种地方写诗？

It is an amazing discovery. The next occurrence, however, is even more surprising.
惊人的发现。可惜，意外总是更令人措手不及。

A bird swoops over and snatches the parchment from his hand like an eagle plucking a fish from the ocean.
鸟儿从他手中抢走稿纸，就如同从雕塑的眼睛上衔走宝石一样轻易。

Journalist: ... Hey!
记者：……嘿！

Journalist: That's mine! I found it! You nasty little thing!
记者：那是我的！我发现的！你这个坏东西！

Journalist: Give it back!
记者：还给我！

Humans who neglect to exercise are no match for wild animals.
疏于锻炼的人类，并非野生动物旗鼓相当的对手。

What this human now faces is a primitive yet most difficult-to-resist ambush.
更何况，这个人类遇上的，是最为低级，同时也最难以招架的偷袭与群殴。

Primitive, but efficient. It is orderly and prepared.
原始，但高效。整齐划一，有备而来。

Journalist: What's going on!?
记者：这突然都是怎么了！

Journalist: How are there so many ...!?
记者：怎么这么多……!?

The birds, dedicated to driving off the intruder, give him no answer.
致力于齐心协力驱逐外来人的鸟儿，并不会回答他的问题。

Bird: *chirps*
鸟：啾啾——

Journalist: P-please, let go of my clothes!
记者：请，请放开我的衣服！

Journalist: Where are you taking me?
记者：你们要带我去哪儿?

Journalist: The parchment!? I don't want the parchment! Give me back my notebook ...
记者：羊皮纸！羊皮纸我不要了！把笔记本还给我……

Journalist: No! That's the brooch my mother left me!
记者：不！那是我母亲留给我的胸针！

In such chaos, opportunities are fleeting.
混乱中，脱身的机会稍纵即逝。

He must grab it and take back what is his!
抓住它，抢回属于自己的东西！

Bird: Chirp.
鸟：啾——

Journalist: You!
记者：你们——

Journalist: Give it to me ... Let go!
记者：都给我——放开！

This sudden surge of resistance deters the birds for a few seconds.
突然爆发的挣扎，显然也具有惊人的、且可持续好几秒的威慑力。

There is a brief pause in their attack. Then, a figure leisurely steps out of the woods.
鸟群的动作有短暂的停顿。随后，一个人影自林中休憩处缓步挪出来。

???: ...
???: ……

???: Please ... ahem ... s-stop.
???: 请……咳咳……停，停下。

???: ... *sigh*.
???: ……唉。

???: Sorry ...
???: 抱歉……

???: ... about ... your mother's brooch ...
???: 为您……您母亲的胸针……

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

唾手偶得
An Easy Discovery BTE-04

An Easy Discovery
唾手偶得

Journalist: ...
记者: ……

Journalist: *"... We grow, yet no one knows,"*
记者: “……我们生长，却无人知晓”

Journalist: *"Like poplars in the winter."*
记者: “像寒冬的白杨”

Journalist: Did you write that?
记者: 这是您写的吗?

Journalist: It's beautiful. But ...
记者: 真的很美。但……

Зима: ...?
冬: ……?

Journalist: Could you please ask your bear friend to stand a little further back?
记者: 您能不能先让您的熊朋友，站远些?

The huge brown bear stands stubbornly between the two, a mighty guard.
巨大的棕熊，像一个威猛的护卫，执着地伫立在两人中间。

Зима: ... S-sorry.
冬: ……抱，抱歉。

Зима: Mr. Medvedevich, please, stand ... on my left.
冬: 梅德维奇先生，请、您站……到我的左手边来。

Journalist: You can talk to them?
记者: 您能和它们说话?

Зима: More than that ... We communicate.
冬: 更好的……交流。

Journalist: Okay ... I have a few questions. In recompense for what you just put me through, could you answer them for me?
记者: 好的……我还有一些问题，看在刚才的闹剧的份上，您能为我解答一下吗?

Зима: Go ahead.
冬: 请……请。

Journalist: Why did you come here?
记者: 您是为什么来到这里的?

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Journalist: If you prefer not to say, I'll ask a different question.
记者: 如果您不愿说，那我换一个问题——

There is a brief struggle in the poet's mind.
诗人头脑中短暂地发生了一场抗争。

Eventually, his rationality to end this quickly defeats his desire for silence.
最终，想要快些应付过去的理智，还是打败了沉默的欲望。

Зима: ... Because of ... a poem ... for the Tsar. I didn't want to write one.
冬：……为……为沙皇……作诗。我不愿意。

Journalist: I say, the Tsar! So you're a political prisoner who once walked Green Street. I should have guessed earlier.
记者：嗬，沙皇！您是位曾穿绿街的政治犯，我早该猜到的。

Journalist: But sentences mandated by the tsarist government ended long ago. Didn't you know?
记者：但是，对沙皇政府的服刑早已结束了，您不知道吗?

Зима: I don't ... understand.
冬：我不……不了解。

Зима: To me ...
冬：对我来说……

Зима: There isn't ... much ... difference ... who I ... serve the sentence for.
冬：对谁……服刑，并没有……什……么区别。

Journalist: Have you ever thought about going back? You should!
记者：难道您从未想过要回去吗？您应该回去。

Journalist: You have no idea how great the motherland is today ...
记者：您不了解祖国如今的建设，究竟是怎样的……

Зима: ...
冬：……

He remains silent as the reporter blathers on.
他最终还是沉默了，在记者滔滔不绝的背景声中。

The poet raises his head. As far as the eye can see, there is nothing but endless forest.
青年男子抬起头。目之所及，只有铺洒出去漫无尽处的林地。

Where is this "motherland?"
“祖国”在哪里?

Зима: No ...
冬：不……

Зима: ... I already ... belong here.
冬：……我已经……属于这里。

"The poet was not interested in the journalist's suggestions."
“诗人对记者的提议并不感兴趣。”

"However, the journalist did not give up, hoping to change his mind through persistence."
“但记者没有放弃，相信只要坚持，就一定能够打动对方。”

Sonetto: ... I see.
十四行诗：……原来如此。

Sonetto: Maybe I shouldn't ...
十四行诗：也许我不应该——

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Sonetto: I hope this isn't the story of the hunter and the pigeon.
十四行诗： 希望这不是猎人与鸽子的故事。

Journalist: Our cause could use the support of a concise and compelling spokesperson like you.
记者： 我们的事业，正需要您这样笔力简洁、又富有感染力的喉舌支持。

Зима: Ahh ...
冬： 啊……

Journalist: The turns of phrase, the imagery, the metaphors! Every line brims with an innate charm.
记者： 这些灵动的词句，这些意象，这些隐喻！每一处都充满了浑然天成的自然魅力。

Journalist: Sir, even though you refuse to tell me your name ...
记者： 先生，虽然您甚至都不肯告诉我，您的名字……

Journalist: I must invite you again to return with me. I would be more than willing to help you publish these works.
记者： 但我必须再次邀请您，与我一同回去，我愿意帮您将这些创作付梓出版。

Зима: ...
冬： ……

Journalist: If we bring back these manuscripts and transcribe the verses from the stones, ...
记者： 带回这些手稿，和从石头上拓写的诗句——

Journalist: ... your legendary experience surviving Devil's Island, enduring such a harsh environment, yet continuing to create in the face of it all, would surely capture people's attention!
记者： 再对您如何流落恶魔岛，在恶劣的环境中求生，甚至持续创作的传奇经历，稍加润色宣传，一定能吸引所有人的目光！

Journalist: You're a living legend! The last of the old guard! If you return to Moscow, fame, money, and status will all be at your fingertips.
记者： 您这旧时代的最后一人，一个活的传奇……只要您肯回到莫斯科，名声、金钱、地位，简直唾手可得。

The chickadee shakes its head in silent refusal.
山雀摇着头，无声传递拒绝的信号。

Зима shakes his head, too.
于是，他也轻轻摇头。

Journalist: ... No? Why? Isn't that what you want?
记者： ……不？为什么？您不想要这些？

He is clearly puzzled, so much so that he continues to inquire as to his reasoning.
他对此感到相当费解，以至于必须为自己得到的答案寻找一个原因。

Journalist: Or did you not actually write these poems?
记者： 还是说，这些诗，其实不是您写的？

Зима: That's ... not important. Maybe I did write them.
冬： 那……不重要。它可以是，我写的。

Зима: Or maybe ... "зима" wrote them, or Mr. Medvedevich ...
冬： 也可以是……“冬”写的，梅德维奇先生写的……

Journalist: зима?
记者： “冬”？——

Зима: They ... are just—ahem—just "poems." That's ... all.
冬： 它们……只是，咳。只是“诗”。仅……此而已。

Journalist: What do you mean by that!? Are you some sort of responsibility-shafting liberal?
记者： 您这话像什么呀！就跟那些毫无担当的自由主义者似的。

Зима: ...
冬： ……

Зима: What's ... that?
冬： 那是……什么?

Зима: ... And I have no ... "legendary experience."
冬： ……而且，也没有什么……“传奇经历”。

Зима: Suffering ... should not be embellished and ... exploited.
冬： 只是苦难……不该被，渲染和……利用。

Journalist: You obviously have a sense of belonging to this place. You said so yourself.
记者： 可您说，您属于这里。您显然对这地方有了归属感。

Journalist: You've fallen in love with it! Despite its wild, primitive nature.
记者： 您竟然爱上了这样的地方！即使它如此蛮荒，如此原始……

Journalist: That being the case, can this experience really be considered suffering for you?
记者： 既然如此，那这段经历，对您来说还能算作苦难吗?

Зима: ...
冬： ……

Зима: T-this is ... my opinion.
冬： 这是，这……是我的看法。

Зима: You haven't ... seen those who died ...
冬： 而您甚至……没有见过，那些死去的人……

The scorched earth, the collapsed shacks, the desolate forests with few traces of humanity.
烧焦的土地，坍塌的棚屋，罕有人迹的荒林。

The roads paved with bloodstained stones.
沾染血迹的、石块铺就的路。

Where did they come from? Is there anyone who remembers?
从何而来？有谁记得?

Зима: ... because of the cold ... hunger ... injuries and despair.
冬： 因为寒冷……饥饿……伤病，和绝望。

Зима: They are ... right under ... your feet.
冬： 就……在您的……脚下。

Зима: ... *sigh*.
冬： ……唉。

Зима: Go back ... alone. I decline ... your offer.
冬： 您一个人……回去吧。请允许我拒绝……您的提议。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

善辩者满载
Returning with Abundance BTE-05

Returning with Abundance
善辩者满载

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: Please ... don't ... follow me again ...
冬: 请……不要再……跟着我了……

He turns around to leave, beginning to regret his refusal of Mr. Medvedevich's earlier offer.
此刻，他开始有些后悔，后悔先前拒绝了梅德维奇先生的帮助。

The chickadee crouches on his shoulder, keeping a black, seedy eye on the journalist.
唯一同行的山雀，只得蹲在肩膀上，紧紧挨着，时刻警惕。

Journalist: Sir, I have no other choice.
记者: 先生，我也没有别的办法呀。

Journalist: When I arrived here, the boatman told me that it would be at least 14 days before the barge next docked.
记者: 我到这里时，船夫告诉我，统一管理之后，驳船下次靠岸至少还需十四天。

Journalist: Until then ... I really have nowhere else to go.
记者: 在这之前……我实在无处可去。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: So, head south ...
冬: 那么，您往南边……

Journalist: I'll probably die from hopelessness and exhaustion before I ever make it.
记者: 或许走不到南边，我就已经因为失去希望，筋疲力尽而死了。

Journalist: You see, all these things I have with me are just like my life—completely useless!
记者: 您瞧，我身上这些东西，简直就像我的人生——毫无用处！

Journalist: To be honest with you, I've come all the way here and found nothing! Absolutely nothing! I'm totally clueless.
记者: 老实跟您说吧，我千里迢迢来到这里，却什么东西都没找到，对这个流放地的情况，一点头绪都没有。

Journalist: Even if I manage to return alive, I'll be laughed out of the room by my peers. Every part of this horrible trip will have been a total waste of time.
记者: 哪怕活着回去，也是一事无成，浪费了时间，只会被同伴笑话。

Journalist: But if I follow you, and if luck is on my side, I might discover something new.
记者: 跟着您，运气好的话，兴许还能有些别的发现。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Journalist: You seem like a kind-hearted person—
记者: 而且您看上去是个好心人——

Зима: ... I'll ask ... my friend. I'll ask him to lead you to where ... humans gather ...
冬: ……我请……我的朋友，请它领您去，人类……聚居的地方……

The chickadee jumps with dissatisfaction. It seems to be very much against this suggestion.
这话让山雀不满地跳了跳。它似乎非常反对这个提议。

Зима: Alright, alright.
冬：好吧，好吧。

Зима: ...
冬：……

He thinks hard, trying to find a way to satisfy everyone.
为使双方满意，他只能继续艰难地思考着。

Does it usually take this much energy to deal with humans? Maybe he should not have answered any questions in the first place.
应付人类需要这么多的精力吗？也许一开始他就不应该回答任何问题。

Зима: What ... do you want?
冬：您想要……什么？

Journalist: ... *sigh*!
记者：……唉！

Journalist: You still don't get it, do you? All your problems would be solved if you just agreed to let me collect some of your poems and stories!
记者：您还不明白吗？只要您答应，让我收集一些您的诗和故事，所有问题都会迎刃而解！

Journalist: Look, if you agree to this, I'll have the motivation to leave the island. No need to worry about what comes afterwards.
记者：有了成果，也就有了回去的动力。接下来的事情，您就不必担心了。

Journalist: I'll go back to minding my own business. No more following you around—
记者：噢，自然，我也不会再像现在这样跟着您了……

Зима: Is ... that so?
冬：……是……这样吗？

Journalist: Yes!
记者：当然！

Зима: Then ... Ahem, ahem. I ... agree. Take them ...
冬：那么……咳，咳咳。我……同意了。您用吧……

Journalist: ...!!!
记者：……！！！

Journalist: Thank you so much! I'll retain your right of authorship.
记者：非常感谢！我会保留您的署名权。

Зима: I don't need ... credit.
冬：不用……署名。

Journalist: But the author must always be named. Otherwise, what will the readers call you? "The Poet of Devil's Island?"
记者：可作者总需要一个名字，否则读者要如何称呼您呢？就叫您“恶魔岛诗人”吗？

Зима: ... Actually ...
冬：……其实……

He makes eye contact with the chickadee on his shoulder. A name slips off its tongue.
犹豫间，他与肩上的山雀再次对视。一个名字便从舌苔滑出。

Зима: ... "зима" is good.
冬: ……“冬”，就很好。

"The poet gave the journalist permission to take the sheets of parchment."
“诗人给了记者许可，任他带走了那些羊皮纸。”

"But just when he thought that life would return to normal—"
“当他以为生活就会这样恢复平静时——”

Sonetto: ... "thought"?
十四行诗: ……“以为”?

Sonetto: So, it didn't then ...
十四行诗: 所以是没有的意思吗?

Sonetto: Oh, my goodness ...
十四行诗: 哦，天哪……

"More people embarked on the path to the island, paved with blood and stone, in search of his poetry, his stories, and him."
“更多的人，为他的诗、他的故事，又或者仅为了他，踏上了这岛屿被血肉与石块铺成的道路。”

The island has never been more crowded.
岛上人群从未这样熙攘过。

The forest is filled with masses of people. They swell and separate, bumping and shoving into each other like live sardines writhing in an open can.
森林裹覆，人头攒动，如同敞开晃荡的沙丁鱼罐头。

Tourist I: Is this what the papers were talking about? Stones engraved with poetry and fables?
游客 Ⅰ: 这就是报纸上说的，那些刻着诗和寓言故事的石头吗?

Tourist II: It must be. This place is just like the frozen wasteland near my hometown. If you don't work the land until your hands are riddled with frostbite, then nothing comes of the place. It's amazing that зима can continue to create here ...
游客 Ⅱ: 一定是了。这地方简直就像我老家的荒地，你不开垦得满手冻疮，就什么也没有。“冬”先生竟然还能在这里坚持创作，了不起……

Tourist III: It's more than just amazing ... It's downright unbelievable. I heard that зима has been stranded on the island for so long that he can communicate with animals. He's almost a savage.
游客 Ⅲ: 何止是了不起……这简直“不可思议”。我听说“冬”在岛上滞留太久，已经能与动物沟通，几乎完全是个野蛮人了。

Tourist I: ... If someone who can write poetry as great as his is considered a "savage," then doesn't that make the rest of us all the more primitive?
游客 Ⅰ: ……如果能写出这种诗句的人都算“野蛮人”，那我们岂不是更原始了。

Tourist III: Maybe he survives by gathering fruit and hunting?
游客 Ⅲ: 说不定他靠采摘野果和打猎为生呢?

Tourist II: The first person to report on "The Poet of Devil's Island" was the now-editor-in-chief of "The Truth" newspaper, Suvorin. He certainly didn't say anything about that.
游客 Ⅱ: 第一个报道这位“恶魔岛诗人”的，是《真相报》主编苏沃林。他可没有这样记载。

Tourist II: But ... Ha. He got the sheets of parchment with зима's poetry and was promoted from investigative journalist to literary editor as soon as he returned.
游客 Ⅱ: 不过……哈。他得了“冬”写着诗的羊皮纸，一回去就从外派调查记者升职，成了文学主编……

Tourist II: Last month, he sent all the sheets of parchment to an exhibition. I saw them at Mikhailovsky Castle. They were written in French and Russian, and something that looked like Latin ...
游客 II：上个月，他把那些羊皮纸都送去展览了。我在米哈伊洛夫宫见过实物，上面用了法语和俄语写作，还有一些像拉丁语的文字……

Tourist I: So, what you mean to say is that зима can write in three languages and therefore cannot be a true savage.
游客 I：总之，你的意见是，会使用三语写作的“冬”先生，不可能是真正的野蛮人。

Tourist III: He's a cultured savage.
游客 III：有文化的野蛮人。

Tourist I: What an oxymoron ...
游客 I：你这话就像“无用实用学”一样狗屁不通……

Tourist I: Nonetheless, I've been getting more and more curious. His collection of poems has been out for so long, but has anyone actually seen зима in person?
游客 I：不过，这么一说，我倒是越来越好奇了。“冬”的诗集发行这么久了，究竟有没有人见到过本人？

Tourist III: Are you implying something? Do you think this is some kind of elaborate hoax?
游客 III：你在暗示什么吗？比如“这是一个精心策划的骗局”？

Tourist II: I don't see why anyone would set up a hoax to increase tourism to, uh, this place ...
游客 II：我不认为有人会为了，呃，推动这地方的旅游业发展，专门策划这样的骗局……

Tourist II: Besides, the poems on the parchment and on the stones in front of us all seem so real, don't they?
游客 II：我是说，那些诗和羊皮纸，还有面前这些石头，看起来都太真实了，不是吗？

Tourist II: Anyway, I hope this is all real. I traveled here so that I might see him in person.
游客 II：而且，我正是为了见一见他本人，才来到这里的。

Tourist II: Chekhov's "Journey to a Distant Island" already seems like a hoax to me at this point. The conditions here are much worse than the book described.
游客 II：《远岛旅行记》对我来说已经像一场“骗局”了。这地方的实际环境，比书里所描写的，要恶劣太多。

Tourist I: Did you forget about the war ...?
游客 I：战争，你忘了么……

Tourist II: Well, зима doesn't mention that in his works.
游客 II：唉。“冬”的文字里，就没有这东西。

The sound of their discussion echoes through the forest.
林地深处，讨论的声音逐渐远去。

The echoes reach the ears of a neatly uniformed duo, a little way away. They are approaching.
另一边，还有一支身穿齐整制服的小队，也走到了这热闹的地界。

Investigator II: The person living on this island must be quite eccentric. I mean, engraving words on rocks by the sea ...
调查员 II：住在这座岛上的一定是个有趣且古怪的家伙。瞧，先是在海边的岩石上随机刻字……

Investigator II: Traces of arcane skills on the beach ...
调查员 II：没走几步路，沙滩上也找得见施术痕迹……

Investigator II: Heh, we even found writing on the cliffs in places where a pigeon couldn't perch.
调查员 II：然后，嘿，在铁翅都不一定挂得住的悬崖上，还能写。

Investigator II: Although the traces are obvious, they are totally irregular. Interesting.
调查员 II： 虽然行迹明显，但完全算不上规律。有意思。

Investigator II: Oh, maybe this time we'll encounter a bear with several doctorates and serious social anxiety ... like Mr. Mishka.
调查员 II： 喔，说不定这次我们要碰上的是一头修了好几个博士学位、有严重社交障碍的熊什么的……比如，“米什卡先生”?

Investigator I: Don't make such arbitrary guesses. Especially about such boring nonsense.
调查员 I： 不要随意评判，胡乱猜测。尤其是这种无聊的梦话。

Investigator I: Quit contemplating and focus on the mission.
调查员 I： 减少抱怨，专注任务。

Investigator I: There are even more arcane skill fluctuations here than on the cliffs ...
调查员 I： 这附近……还有比悬崖上更多的施术波动。

Investigator II: That proves we're on the right track. Where are these fluctuations?
调查员 II： 那正说明我们走对了路——您说的波动在哪儿呢?

Investigator I: ...
调查员 I： ……

Investigator I: On those rocks up ahead.
调查员 I： 就在前面那些石头上。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

街上的诗人
Poet in the Street BTE-06

Poet in the Street
街上的诗人

The two Foundation investigators trudge through the snow, like two cats with broken whiskers, making their way towards the rocks.
两位深一脚、浅一脚踩着雪的基金会调查员，像两只断了胡须的猫，徘徊于森林外围。

Investigator II: It's rather crowded ... If we dug down right here, do you think we'd strike oil?
调查员 II： 这儿还挺热闹……难道在这地上随便打个洞，也能流出石油来吗?

Investigator I: I suggest we wait for the crowd in front of that rock to disperse a bit before we collect samples from the carvings on it.
调查员 I： 我建议，等某块石头前的人群稍微散开，再过去采集上面的刻痕样本。

Investigator II: Got it. You are the chief investigator, after all. What choice do I have but to listen to you?
调查员 II： 没问题。这里只有我俩，您是队长，当然听您的。

Investigator I: Even so, I'd rather we make decisions together.
调查员 I： 即便如此，队内决议流程也是必须的。

Investigator II: Understood! Not to interrupt, but there seems to be some commotion over there.
调查员 II： 收到！不过，我不是有意打断您——好像那边出现了什么骚动。

Investigator II: By the—let me see ... the biggest rock over there.
调查员 II： 在——我看看——最大的石块那边。

Investigator II: I suggest we go over and see what's going on.
调查员 II： 提议，我们现在过去瞧个明白?

Investigator I: ... Agreed.
调查员 I： ……附议。

As they approach, the sound of argumentation grows louder. The debaters are stubbornly holding their ground.
几句争论，大段各执一词。

A crowd has gathered around them, awaiting the result with bated breath.
人们久留于原地，等待共识的出现。

Tourist I: ... But it wouldn't be impossible to develop this island, even so far from the mainland ... After all, that's what several tsars spent two hundred years doing.
游客 I： ——不过，如果是为了开发这远离本土的岛屿，也并非不可能……毕竟这确实是好几位沙皇，花了两百年都没做到的事。

Tourist III: So if these are fake, who is зима's ghostwriter?
游客 III： 那如果这些都是假造，这位“冬”先生，又是由谁代笔呢?

Tourist II: I still don't think there's a ghostwriter ...
游客 II： 我还是相信我的判断，没有代笔……

Tourist II: Whether written on parchment or stone, there is an amazingly consistent and special warmth maintained in the language. It would be extremely difficult for a city dweller to emulate it.
游客 II： 因为不管是写在羊皮纸，还是石头上，这种语言中维持的惊人一致的特殊温度，都是长期生活在城市中的人所难以仿制的。

Tourist II: I'd really like to meet the author ...
游客 II： 真想见见作者本人……

After a brief silence, the dissenter speaks again. This time with words of praise.
短暂的沉默之后，异见的发表者再度开口，吐露的却是褒奖。

Tourist III: He's actually quite admirable.
游客 III： 其实还挺令人佩服的。

Tourist I: ... The "savage," you mean?
游客 I： ……这个你口中的，“野蛮人”?

Tourist III: Think about it: if it's true, then this person has been living here in this place for all these years. Somehow, he's survived while writing beautiful poetry in the process. And for some reason, he never escaped or left, even after becoming famous.
游客 III： 你想想，如果这是真的，那么这个人在，呃，这种地方，生活了这些年，一直没有逃走，也没有死去，并且还在写诗，成名也没有离开。

Tourist III: On the other hand, if it's false, it still means that someone has taken the time to scratch all these poems into these stones and write in three languages on those parchment papers you saw ... It's quite a feat.
游客 III： 如果是假的，那也需要造假这么多的石头诗，和你看到的那些多语写作羊皮纸……仍然是个不小的工程。

Tourist II: Yes, from that perspective, it's remarkable nonetheless.
游客 II： 是的，从这个角度来说也很难得。

Tourist I: It actually is ...
游客 I： 这也确实……

A consensus, however brief, has been reached.
共识，存在得比眨眼更短暂。

A new voice of dissent echoes from somewhere in the crowd.
更多、更多异见的回响，从人群里某个地方传来。

???: H-how disappointing.
???: 太，太失望了。

???: There's nothing ... r-remarkable.
???: 也没什么……了、了不起的。

???: One could see this ... anywhere.
???: 简直……随处可见。

???: Even a ... child could write this ...
???: 就算是，识字的……小孩子，也能写出来……

"The crowds seemed to have ruined everything."
“吵嚷的人群似乎把一切都打乱了。”

"They continuously poured onto the island, expressing their opinions about the engraved stones."
“他们源源不断涌入岛上，对着刻字石头输出自己的见解。”

"They persistently searched for any trace of the poet's existence."
“或执着地搜寻着，标志诗人存在的一切痕迹。”

"But, this time, the poet did not hide."
“诗人这次没有远远躲起来。”

"He tried his best to get everything back to normal."
“他尽力想让一切回到正轨。”

Tourist II: Excuse me, do you know the poet? How else could you make such a judgment?
游客 II: 请问您，认识这位诗人吗？否则是怎样下的判断呢？

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: Anyone ... with eyes ... can see it ...
冬: 有……有眼睛的人……都，都能看出来……

Tourist I: Then you have insulted not just the poet but all of us too!
游客 I: 那您可一下侮辱了许多人。

Зима: These ... lines ... are so b-blunt and crude. The technique is ... inferior.
冬: 这些……句子……太过直、直白，简陋。手法……低劣。

Зима: It's like sticking straw ... into the tundra and p-praising ... the land's vitality ...
冬: 就像把麦秆……插在苔原上。然后，赞、赞美它的……生命力……

Tourist II: Do you think you could write better?
游客 II: 您难道就写得更好吗？

Зима: ... I-it's just ... nonsense ... carved into stone ...
冬: ……不、不过是刻在……石头上的……胡言乱语……

Зима: Even you ... could write ... better.
冬: 您也……也能写得……更好。

Tourist III: I suppose you are a famous poet yourself. May I ask what works you've written? When I return, I shall seek them out and read them.
游客 III: 那么，您一定也是位有名的诗人。请问您都有些什么作品？等我回去，一定找来拜读一下。

This comment is met with a wave of laughter. During the conversation, the crowd has divided into two distinct camps.
一阵笑声默契地传递开来。话音间，人群已经成了两个界限分明的阵营。

The instigator, who is vigorously disparaging these poems, stands alone in the center, like Moses after he parted the Red Sea.
卖力贬低这些诗作的“始作俑者”，独自站在视线的中央，像分开红海的摩西。

The difference is that this "Red Sea" has not parted to give way to him, but to allow them to confront him more fiercely.
不同的是，这“红海”之分并非让路的认同，只为了对异见分子更猛烈地反扑。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: I ...
冬: 我……

The chickadee perches on his shoulder, pressing against his neck, eager to alleviate this moment of speechlessness.
山雀站在他肩膀上，紧紧贴着脖颈，似乎急于缓解这阵急促的失语。

Language, whether written by hand or spoken from the tongue, has never seemed so pallid as it does at this moment.
语言，由手写就，或者自舌吐露，从未像此刻这样苍白。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

In the strained silence, a faint, blue, icy halo appears beneath his feet.
局促沉默之中，淡蓝的、冰棱一样的光晕，从他脚下隐约显现了。

The howls of beasts and the cries of birds echo from the forest behind him.
身后的林地里，兽嚎鸟鸣，此起彼伏。

Investigator II: Look! The man in the middle.
调查员 II： 是中间的那个人。

Investigator I: It's the same arcane fluctuation!
调查员 I： 一样的施术波动。

Investigator II: He looks pretty much the same as the others. Is he the arcanist who's been carving things all over the place?
调查员 II： 瞧上去和大伙儿也差不多。他就是那位到处刻字的神秘学家?

Investigator I: He must be. And now we know why.
调查员 I： 嗯。现在我们知道为什么了。

Investigator I: He's a poet.
调查员 I： 他是位诗人。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

在寒夜中……
In the Cold Night ... BTE-07

In the Cold Night ...
在寒夜中……

Beneath the cliff, a hidden conversation quietly unfolds.
悬崖下，一场隐蔽的对话悄然展开。

... Provided that "conversation" is understood in the loosest sense of the word.
……前提是，“对话”的字面定义有了新的拓展。

Investigator I: We know you're trying to dispel the influx of people coming here.
调查员 Ⅰ： 我们知道，你是想驱散涌入此地的普通人。

Investigator I: Otherwise, you wouldn't have risked exposing yourself by coming out and disparaging your own work.
调查员 Ⅰ： 否则也不会冒着暴露的风险，出来贬低自己的作品。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Investigator II: Even if you criticize your own writing as worthless ...
调查员 Ⅱ： 就算你把自己写的东西批判得一文不值……

Investigator II: ... the people who are already here will not leave easily.
调查员 Ⅱ： 已经来到这儿的人们也不会轻易离开。

Investigator II: Alright. We'll register you as a slightly extreme, reclusive arcanist.
调查员 Ⅱ： 好吧。一位将被登记的、行动稍显激进的、避世的神秘学家。

Investigator I: He's a poet.
调查员 Ⅰ： 一位诗人。

Зима: ... *sigh*.
冬: ……唉。

The chickadee flaps up and down uneasily.
山雀不安地上下翻飞着。

Зима: It's alright ...
冬: 没关系……

Investigator II: ... Sorry, what did you say?
调查员 Ⅱ： ……抱歉，您说什么？

Investigator I: I think he was talking to his bird.
调查员 Ⅰ： 我认为，他是在和他的小鸟说话。

Investigator II: Oh, I've heard about that—that some people can communicate with animals. Like chatting with a pike while ice fishing ...
调查员 Ⅱ： 喔，我知道那个，关于一些人能和动物交流的说法。比如和冰窟窿里的狗鱼聊天儿……

Investigator II: A well-meaning fisherman is likely to master that skill. Or, have you heard the fairytale—
调查员 Ⅱ： 幸运儿、笨拙的人、某个好心的渔夫都有可能掌握这门技术。或者说，你有没有听过一个童话——

Investigator I: He's an arcanist.
调查员 Ⅰ： 他是一名神秘学家。

Зима: I ...
冬：我……

Investigator I: Therefore, I must remind you that your previous actions violated the Public Security Law.
调查员 I：因此我必须提醒，你先前的举动，涉嫌违反《公共区域安全法》。

Investigator I: You may not have meant any harm, but they were dangerous nonetheless.
调查员 I：也许你并不存在强烈的攻击意图，但仍然非常危险。

Зима: ...
冬：……

The chickadee chirps fiercely, trying to argue with them.
山雀啁啾，似乎在激烈地抗辩。

The poet remains silent.
而沉默的人，仍然沉默。

Investigator II: There's no need to be so serious; nothing bad happened, did it?
调查员 II：也不用这么严肃，这不是没出什么事吗?

Investigator I: It's part of our job to handle these things before they become a problem.
调查员 I：在事情变麻烦之前处理好它，也是工作的一部分。

Investigator II: Alright, alright.
调查员 II：没问题，没问题。

Investigator II: I think I mentioned when I introduced myself earlier that we are investigators from the St. Pavlov Foundation. This is a routine investigation to locate arcanists ...
调查员 II：刚才自我介绍的时候好像说到过，我们是圣洛夫基金会的调查员。这是一次寻找神秘学家的例行调查……

Зима: ...
冬：……

Investigator I: When we docked, we detected a large-scale fluctuation in arcane skills.
调查员 I：靠岸时，我们在附近发现了神秘术的波动，并且范围不小。

Investigator II: Those carvings in the bizarre spots on the cliffs—you wrote those, right? But I didn't quite understand them, haha.
调查员 II：那些在悬崖上的、位置吊诡的刻痕——是您写的诗吧？但我没太看懂，哈哈。

Investigator I: ...
调查员 I：……

Investigator I: Don't pay any attention to him ...
调查员 I：您不必理会他……

Зима: ...
冬：……

Зима: Y-Yes.
冬：是……是的。

A small gap opens in the stone wall that is his silence, letting a sliver of light shine through.
沉默像一堵石墙，张开罅隙，也透出光来。

Зима: Those ... poems ...
冬：那些……诗……

Investigator I: ... You wrote them, right? They're beautiful. Even though their location is a little strange—
调查员 I： ……是您写的诗，对吗？它们很美。虽然出现的位置，的确有些奇怪——

It is best to talk about poetry with a poet. It gives them some distance between themselves and their words, allowing them to speak more freely.
应当与诗人聊起诗。诗会为他们提供出逃的空隙与言语的气力。

Standing before the gap in the stone, a happy expression at last appears on the poet's exhausted face.
站在这空隙之前，诗人疲倦的面容上，终于出现少许快乐的神采。

Зима: They're ... allegorical poems.
冬： 是……寓言诗。

Зима: ... I wrote them ... for ... passing birds to read.
冬： ……是，写给，路过的……鸟儿看的。

"The investigators from the St. Pavlov Foundation gave the poet another choice."
“来自圣洛夫基金会的调查员，为诗人提供了其他的选择。”

"A choice he had never imagined he would be presented with and was genuinely shaken by."
“一个他此前从未想见，却真正为之动摇的选择。”

Sonetto: Then, Mr. Зима ... joined the Foundation?
十四行诗： 于是冬先生……就加入了基金会？

Sonetto: So—
十四行诗： 所以——

Investigator II: ... In summary, the St. Pavlov Foundation can provide you with a quiet, safe, creative environment, perhaps even an arcanist companion for you to talk to, and so on and so forth. If you have any special requirements, the specific terms can be negotiated further.
调查员 II： ——综上所述，圣洛夫基金会可以为你提供安静、安全的创作环境，或许还有聊得来的神秘学家同伴，等等等等。如果您有特殊要求，具体条款也还能再商议——

Investigator I: Registration does not affect an arcanist's freedom of movement. We simply need to know your whereabouts.
调查员 I： 登记在册并不影响神秘学家来去自由，我们只是需要知道每个人的位置。

Investigator II: Indeed. In fact, many arcanists like yourself, who prefer to be alone, agree to be registered. After all, there's no harm in it. Why not think it over?
调查员 II： 是的。其实许多像您这样，更乐意自己呆着的神秘学家，都会同意登记。毕竟没什么坏处，不如考虑一下？

Investigator II: Ah, yes, I almost forgot to ask. What's your name?
调查员 II： 啊，对，差点儿忘了问。您的名字是？

Зима: ...
冬： ……

The chickadee flies from one shoulder to the other.
山雀从肩这头，飞向另一头。

It happily chirps a word. A name.
它欢叫着，同一个词语，同一个名字。

Зима: ... "зима."
冬： ……“冬”。

Investigator II: зима, right? Okay.
调查员 II： “冬”，对吗？好的。

Investigator II: I understand that this place might be more familiar to you than your motherland. The idea of a motherland is symbolic, after all. I'm sure you are more aware of that than most, given your literary leanings.
调查员 II： 我其实能够理解，这儿对您来说或许比故乡还要亲切。“祖国”只是个意象，更何况你们用笔杆子吃饭的总是讲究这些。

Investigator II: Oh, listen to me. Whether you make a living with your pen or your hands, it's all the same ... Anyway, you don't have to make a decision right away; we'll be staying on the island for some time.
调查员 II： 哦，瞧我说的。笔杆子吃饭，手指头吃饭，都一样……总之，您不必立刻做出决定，我们还会在岛上逗留一段时间。

Investigator I: Yes. This area is yet to be explored by the Foundation.
调查员 I： 是的。这块地区对基金会来说，还是尚待发掘的区域。

Investigator I: There may be other arcanists.
调查员 I： 说不定，还有其他的神秘学家。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима knows there are no other arcanists here.
冬知道，这里没有其他神秘学家了。

He has touched every rock that the sea strikes along the shore, has spent countless nights under the moonlight wandering through dark pines, and has sat by many campfires reading poetry.
他曾触摸岸边每一块被海水扑打的岩石，伴月光于幽暗的针叶下穿梭，也坐在篝火前读诗。

In the six-month-long winter, amidst the fierce gusts of the westerly wind and the brief warmth of a clearing sky—
在长达六个月的漫长冬季里，西风猎猎的狂飙中，或者短暂放晴的回暖时——

There is no one else. No other arcanists. Just him and his friends.
没有其他人。没有其他神秘学家。只有他，与他的朋友们。

He knows, and he knows it well.
他知道，他熟悉。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: I don't ...
冬: 我不……

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: I don't know.
冬: 我不知道。

From the forest to the cliffs to the coast.
从林中，走向悬崖，再到海岸边。

Thoughts and hesitations draw out time to infinity.
思索、犹豫，似乎无限拉长了时间。

Зима looks out at the rising sun from the end of the long, empty dock.
冬能看到，此时空旷码头延伸的尽头，太阳，升起来了。

A distant, semi-circle; a fire held in the hands of the night, splitting sea from sky.
半轮小小的光晕，黑夜中徒手捧起的火，连海也一并撕裂。

It is bright enough to scorch the eyes, or at least enough to make them sting.
这亮足以烧灼双眼，或仅能使其刺痛。

Everything feels small before this vast horizon.
——在那背后，那庞大的地平线之前，一切都相当渺小。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

空中雁
Something Else BTE-08

Something Else
空中雁

"The poet accepted."
“诗人接受了。”

"He completed the registration the next month, the only additional condition being that he would 'continue to stay on the island.'"
“他于次月完成登记，附加内容仅有‘继续留驻岛上’一条。”

"After three months of negotiations, the Foundation retrieved the exhibited manuscripts from the authorities."
“之后，经过双方三个月的协商，基金会从当局手中，收回了那些被展览的诗稿。”

"But the poet never returned to take them."
“但诗人从未回来带走它们。”

"The original copies are currently housed in the Far East branch of the Foundation library. Copies are also available for reference at other branches."
“回收的诗稿原件，目前藏于基金会远东分部图书馆，其他分部留有复印件可供查阅。”

Sonetto: The library ...
十四行诗：图书馆……

Sonetto: I'll go check there in a bit.
十四行诗：等下去图书馆看看吧。

She leafs through to the end of the file. There is only a half-blank page and the hard back cover.
档案册被翻阅到尽头，仅余空白的半页和尾部硬壳。

Scrawled in the margin is an almost imperceptible signature.
空白处，是一个不易察觉的签名。

зима
“冬”。

Sonetto: ... But before I go, there's one more thing I have to do.
十四行诗：……在此之前，还有一件事。

The sky is brightening as the morning mist clears. Platinum awnings dot the beach.
天光大亮，雾气拂散，白金的芒点遍洒海滩。

In the distance, a heavy barge from Amur is outlined against the shore.
远处，从阿穆尔驶来的重载驳船，往岸边递出一个模糊的轮廓。

Magnificent, yet small. It bobs like an iceberg floating in the sea.
宏伟，却也渺小。譬如海中行走的冰山。

Зима: ... The ship is here.
冬: ……船，来了。

Зима stands on the dock, surveying the scene as he did when he first set foot on the island.
冬站在码头上，如同第一次踏上这片岛屿时那样眺望。

The chickadee by his ear chirps a question, and he answers.
耳边山雀吱喳地问话，他便回答。

Зима: I still ... don't know.
冬: 我还是……不知道。

Зима: Perhaps I should go to the Foundation.
冬: 也许我，应该去基金会。

Зима: Just like they said ...
冬: 像他们说的那样……

Зима: There are many people ... like me there.
冬: 那里还有许多……同我一样的人。

Зима: I can write poems and forget all about the wilderness, fires, sickness, and hunger ...
冬: 我也能写诗，且不必理会荒芜、焚劫、病痛和饥饿……

Зима: I won't be bothered by those people.
冬: 不必理会那些人。

Зима: It'll be like ... heaven.
冬: 就像……“天堂”。

Зима: I just need to board the ship.
冬: 只需要，登上这艘船。

Зима: Do you understand?
冬: 你明白吗?

The chickadee sings a poem, which fails to answer the question.
山雀唱了一首诗，答非所问了。

A fleeting smile crosses Зима's face.
冬的脸上，露出细微而短暂的笑容。

Зима: ... You understand.
冬: ……你明白。

Зима: But ...
冬: 但是……

Зима: Here, the sun and moon are eternal.
冬: 这里，永恒的太阳，永恒的月亮。

Зима: Eternal stones, walnut shells, parchment, and ...
冬: 永恒的石头，胡桃壳，和羊皮纸。

Зима: ... all of you.
冬: 还有……你们。

Зима: ...
冬: ……

Зима: The joys of heaven are too vast and too remote ...
冬：天堂的幸福，太庞大，也太遥远……

Зима: ...
冬：……

Зима: Let's go back.
冬：我们回去吧。

Corridor, Suitcase
箱中走廊

The corridor leading to the library is as empty as it was when she left.
通往图书室的走廊，还像她离开时那样，空无一人。

Sonetto: Mr. Зима is usually here at this hour ...
十四行诗：以往这个时间，冬先生通常都在这里……

Sonetto: I hope he didn't change his plans.
十四行诗：希望他不会突然改变行程。

Sonetto gently knocks on the half-open door.
十四行诗轻轻叩响敞开的门。

Sonetto: ... Mr. Зима?
十四行诗：……冬先生?

The only response is the chirping of a chickadee.
回答她的只有一阵山雀啁啾的响动。

зима is indeed there, along with a scroll of parchment and a bottle containing a strip of paper.
“冬”确实在这里。连同一卷羊皮纸，和一枚其中留有纸条的玻璃瓶。

Sonetto: That's the parchment I took out earlier.
十四行诗：这似乎，是我之前拿出来的羊皮纸?

Sonetto: And ... a bottle? There's a paper inside. Is it for me?
十四行诗：还有一个……玻璃瓶？里面有张纸条，是给我的吗?

зима gives an earnest nod.
桌上的“冬”煞有介事地点了点头。

Sonetto: Okay. I'm going to open it.
十四行诗：好的。那么，我打开了。

Sonetto: "—Please—read—"
十四行诗：“——请——读——”

Sonetto: Huh? Please read what?
十四行诗：嗯？请读什么——

She looks up. зима has already unfolded the parchment on the table with its beak.
她抬头，甚至不必转向。桌上的羊皮纸已经被“冬”衔住边角展开来。

Sonetto: ... Ah.
十四行诗：……啊。

Of course, a poet would present a poem.
诗人当然会留下诗。

Poetry can give voice to the dead.
诗歌是死去的语言。诗人便使死者复生。

Poetry can be a prophecy or simply an expression of one's thoughts and emotions.
某种谶语，或仅写下所想所感。

英文 / ENGLISH
In one hundred feet of snow,
A dead branch a quill will be, sufficient
To write about the moon's passage both night and day;
To write about the frosted needles caught in treetops, the sound of the wind;
To write about the nothingness of night and the all-embracing sea.
They light a bonfire,
Crackling, flickering,
And before the fire leaves their eyes, they sing,
What did you see?
The rocks do not reply,
But a young voice says,
中文 / CHINESE
百尺长的雪地
枯枝也是羽毛笔，足以
写月亮行走过，昨夜，今日
写树梢勾住的，霜针，风声
写什么也没有的夜色，包容万物的海
也燃篝火
噼啪，闪烁
在眼睛寂灭前，唱着
“你看见了什么?”
石头并不回答
只有，一个年轻的声音

"Humanity."
“人间”

зима's small, distinct black claw marks are stamped on the corner of the parchment.
一枚来自“冬”的，小而清晰的黑色爪印，踩在羊皮纸的末端。

A budding sprout, the branching veins of a leaf, ...
初发的嫩芽，或叶脉上长开的分叉。

The two signatures form a journey that has never been taken.
两枚签名，组成一场未曾踏出的旅行。

THE END
THE END